

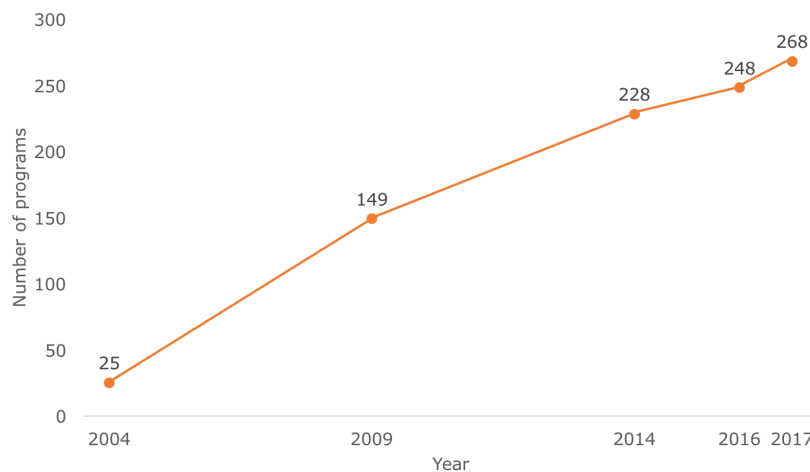


Postsecondary Education for Students with Intellectual Disability: Emerging Evidence

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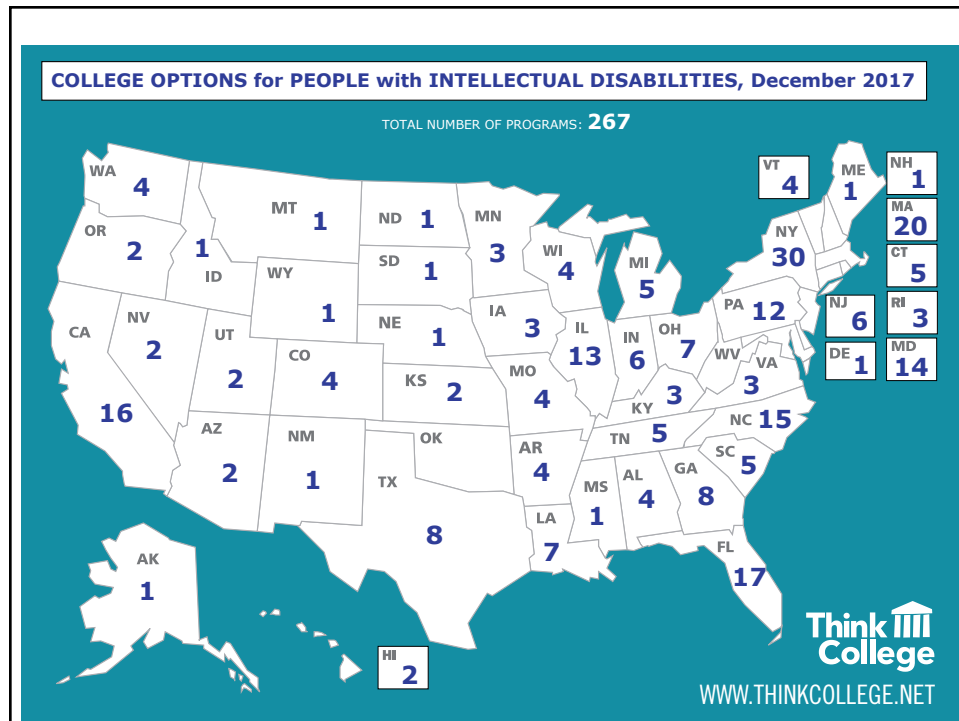
 **ThinkCollege**
NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

Growth in Higher Education Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability in the U.S.



The TPSID National Coordinating Center at Think College is a project of the Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston.
The Center is funded by the Office of Postsecondary Education Grant #P407B100002.





Higher Education Opportunity Act of 2008 (HEOA) Provisions Related to Students with Intellectual Disability (ID)

- **Model Demonstration Programs:** Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disability (TPSIDs) authorized to enable institutions of higher education (IHEs) to create or expand high-quality inclusive programs for students with ID.
- **National Coordinating Center (NCC):** Authorized to provide technical assistance, coordination between and evaluation of TPSID projects, and create recommended model standards for programs through an Accreditation Workgroup.
- **Federal Student Aid:** Eligibility for Pell grants, Federal Supplemental Educational Opportunity Grants and Work-Study jobs.



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Definition in HEOA:



A student—

“(A) with intellectual disability characterized by significant limitations in—

“(i) intellectual and cognitive functioning; and

“(ii) adaptive behavior as expressed in conceptual, social, and practical adaptive skills; and

“(B) who is currently, or was formerly, eligible for a free appropriate public education under the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act.

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What is a CTP?

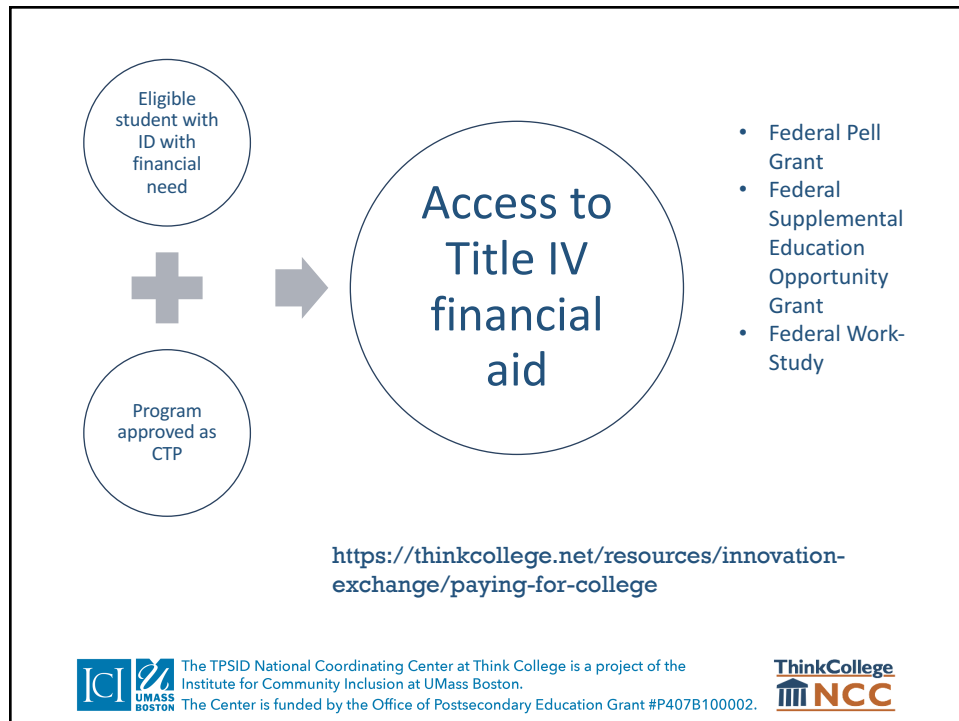
- Comprehensive Transition and Postsecondary (CTP) Program
- Pathway to Title IV (i.e., federal) financial aid for students with intellectual disability (ID)
- Traditional requirements for accessing Title IV financial aid:
 - Required to be working toward a degree or certificate
 - Required to have a high school diploma, GED, or have passed an ability-to-benefit test

CTP removes these barriers
for students with ID



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Outcomes of the Legislation

- Programs at 88 colleges and universities
- Data on 2700+ students (courses, employment)
- Legitimized flexible access into universities and financial aid
- Set standards for inclusion
- Emphasized employment as a goal of higher education
- Established credential benchmark



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Categories of College Programs

- **Transition and Postsecondary Programs for Students with Intellectual Disabilities**
 - Model Demonstration projects funded by the US Department of Education, Office of Postsecondary Education
- **Comprehensive Transition Programs**
 - Programs that have been through an approval process and can offer access to federal financial aid
- **College-based Transition Program**
 - Programs serving transition aged youth 18-22 in college settings for final 2-3 years of transition program.



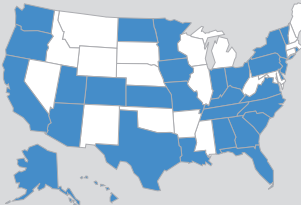
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TPSID COHORT 1 & 2 (2010–2016)

More than 2,700 students served

88 CAMPUSES 

31 STATES 

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.

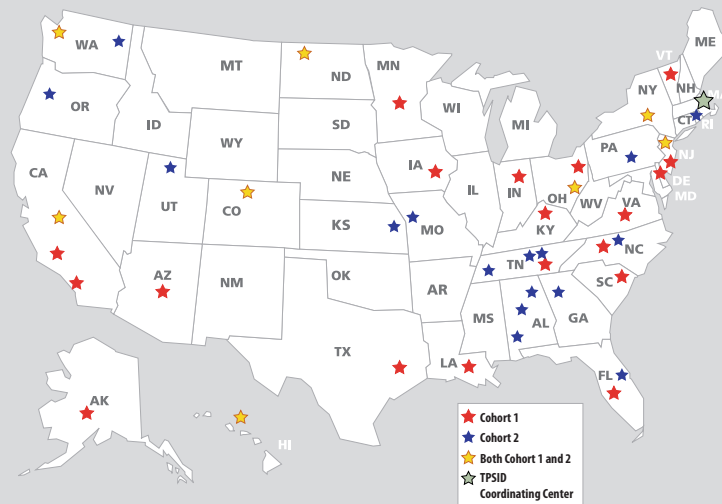
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Positive Impact of TPSIDs

- Enhanced public awareness
- Engagement with new institutions of higher education (IHEs)
- Generation of new state policies, funding, legislation
- Data-based verifying that students with ID *can* go to college



TPSID 2010-2020 GRANTEES



TPSID Cohort 1 & 2 Trend Data (2010–2016)

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.

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Key Outcomes from TPSID Cohort 1

- 2,245 students attended programs at 57 college and university campuses implementing 27 model demonstration grants
- Students enrolled in over 10,000 inclusive courses
- 846 students worked in a paid job while also attending the program
- Students held a total of 1,668 different jobs
- Of these, 1,496 (67%) had exited by the end of the 5-year funding period.
- Of the students employed at exit, 90% were in jobs that are integrated and in the competitive labor market



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Cohort 2

PROGRAMS



25 grantees

44 Institutes of Higher Education (IHEs)

10 2-year IHEs

34 4-year IHEs

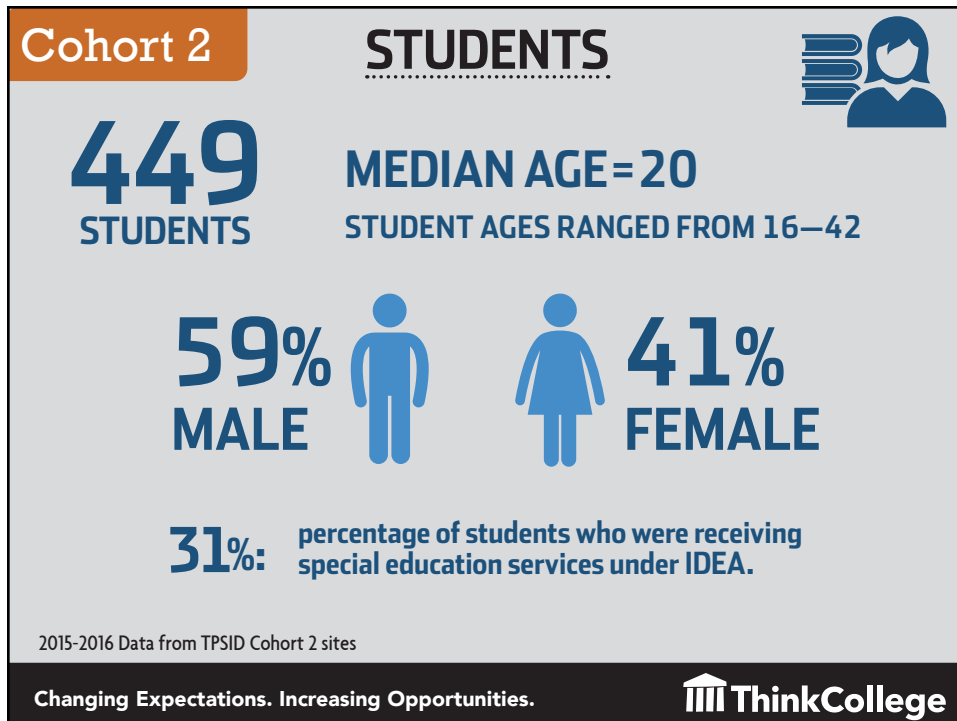
12 Comprehensive Transition Programs

15 serve transition-aged high school students

2015-2016 Data from TPSID Cohort 2 sites

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.



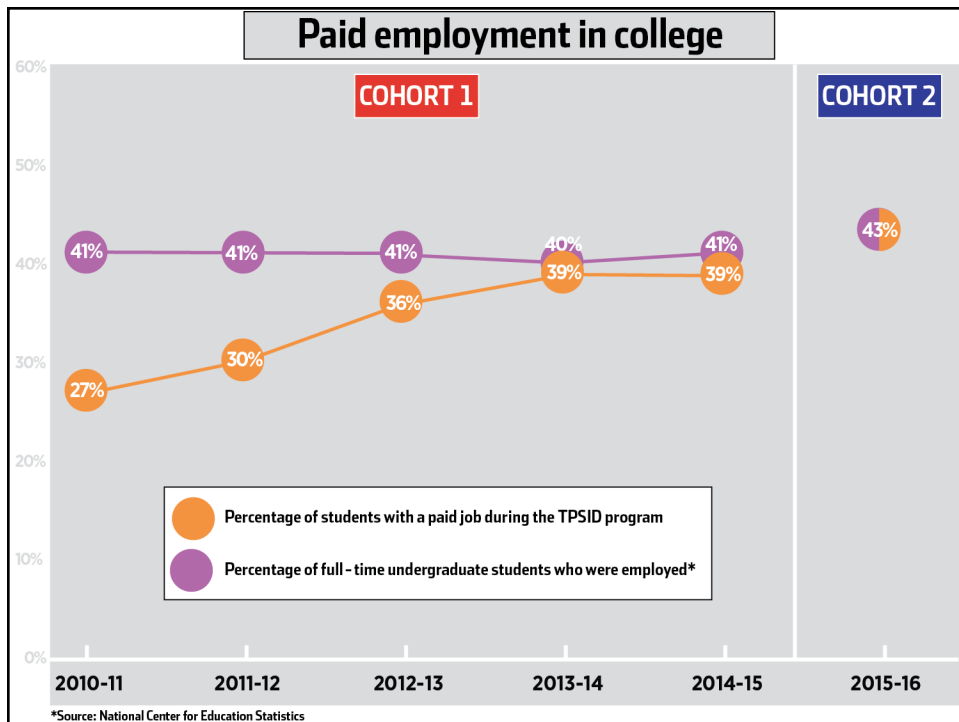
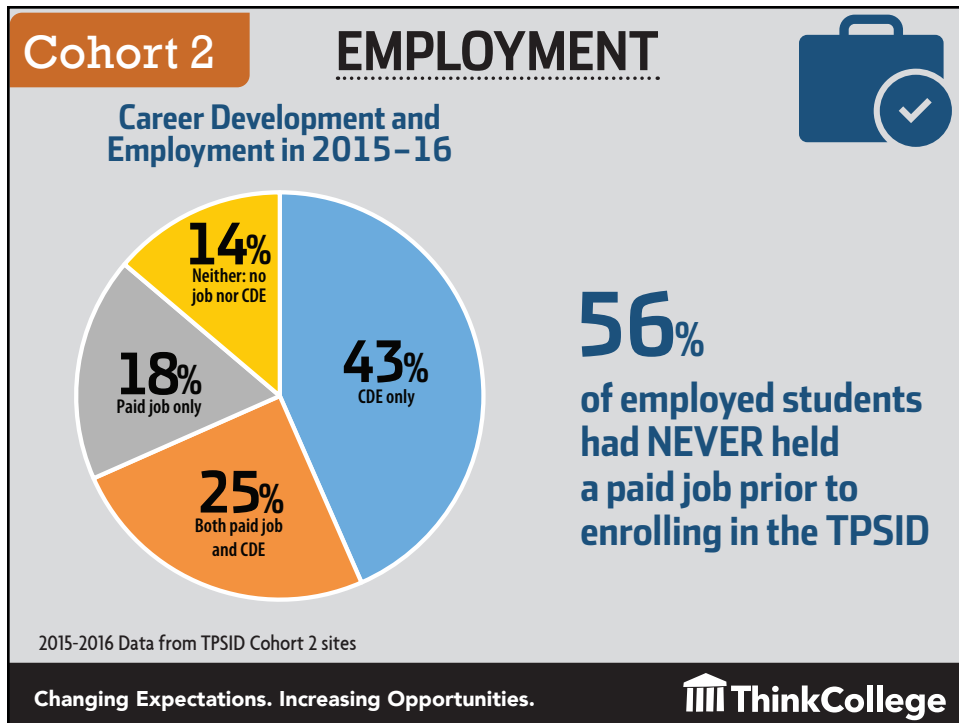


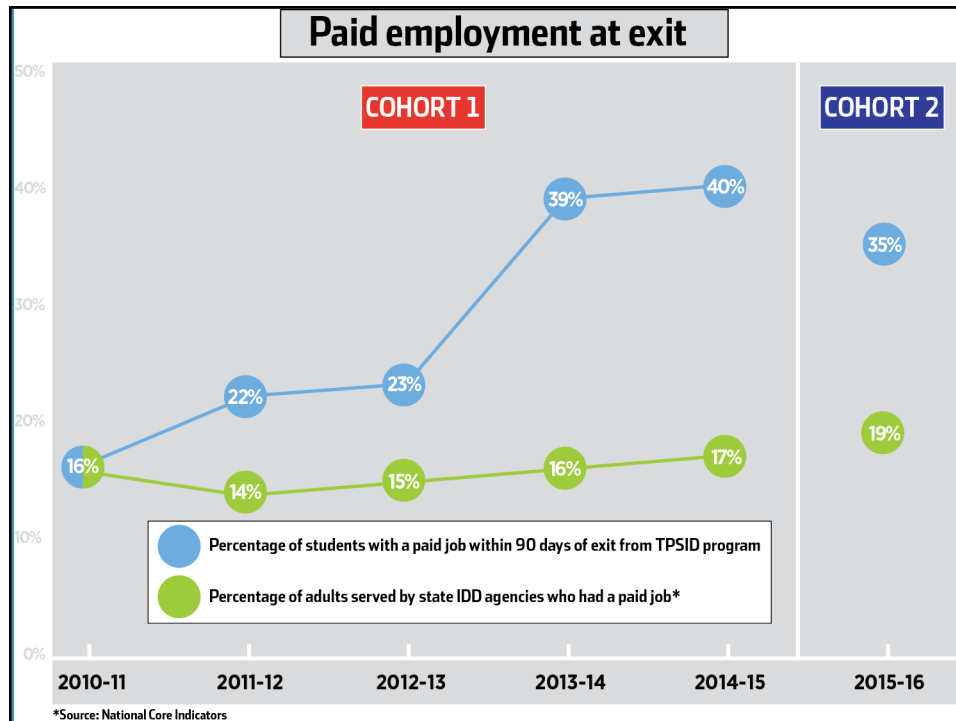
EMPLOYMENT



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ACADEMICS



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Between 2010-2015

- Inclusive course access was established or broadened in most TPSIDs
- Over 10,000 inclusive courses were attended by students enrolled in TPSIDs
- 76% of these courses were taken for some type of credit



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ACADEMICS



3

Average number academically inclusive courses students enrolled in per year

60%

Percentage of students who received accommodations or supports from the disability services office

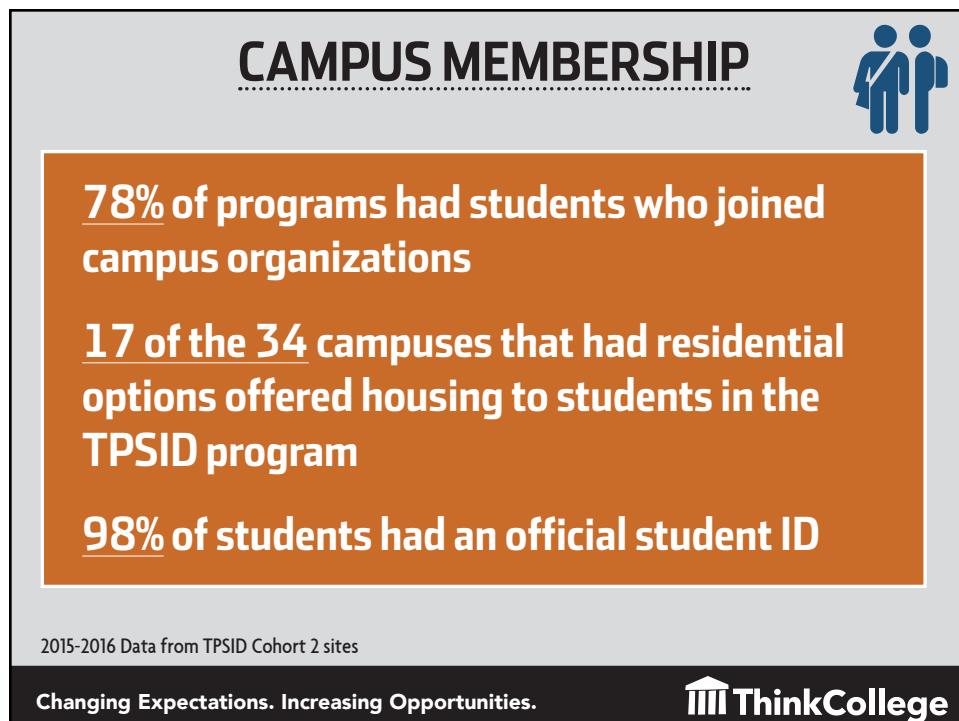
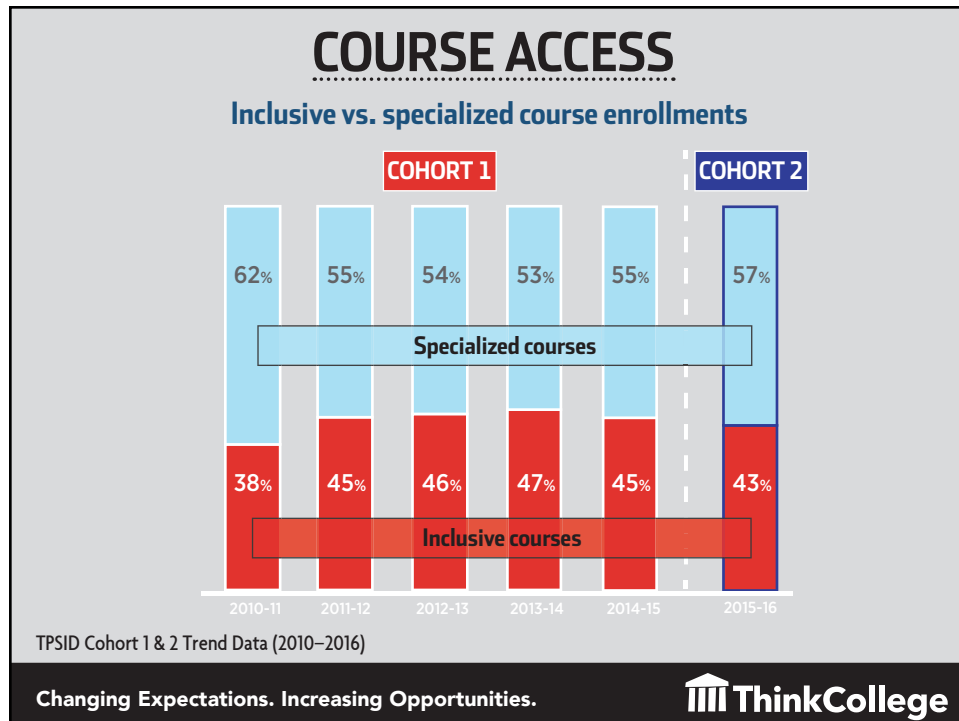
Students who attended programs that were more inclusive were significantly more likely to have a paid job while in the program than students who attended less inclusive programs.

(54.2% vs. 39.1%, $p = .002$)

2015-2016 Data from TPSID Cohort 2 sites

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.







“So what?”

- Existing infrastructure is important!
 - Offers trained staff that understand policy, protocols, and systems that can be used or may need to be tweaked when trying to support engagement with students with ID
- Residential access offers opportunity to become full member of campus community and gain independence



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Employment differences 2 & 4 Yr IHEs

- Students at 4-year IHEs were more likely to participate in both paid employment and other career development activities.
- 33% of students at two-year IHEs had paid work, compared with 45% of students at four-year IHEs.
- 73% of employed students at 2 year IHEs had an individual paid job compared to 66% of employed students attending four-year IHEs.
- Among employed students, those enrolled at two-year IHEs were more likely to have a job that paid above minimum wage than students at four-year IHEs (65% vs. 50%).



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Connection between inclusion and employment

- Students who attended more academically inclusive programs,, were more likely to participate in both paid employment and other career development activities than students who attended programs that were less academically inclusive
- Fifty-eight percent of students at more inclusive programs had a paid job in Year Four. This is the highest percentage of students employed across all subgroups examined.

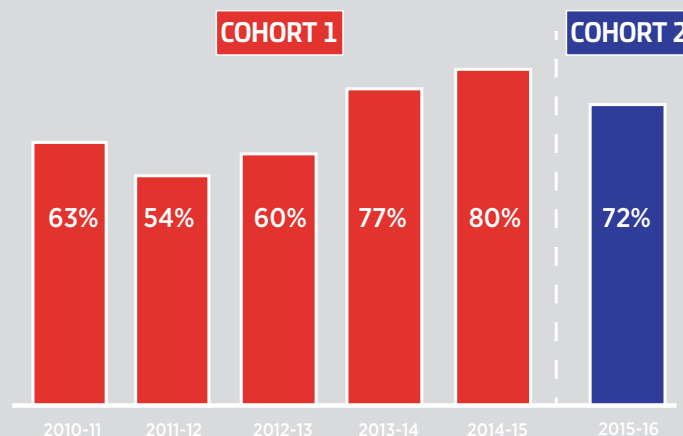


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CREDENTIAL ATTAINMENT

Percentage of students who earned a credential



TPSID Cohort 1 & 2 Trend Data (2010–2016)

Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.





“So what?”

- It matters what students with ID get out of college
- Think about:
 - What does everyone else get out of college?
 - How do other colleges view the credential?
 - How do employers view the credential?
 - What should you tell parents/students about the credential?



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Other positive outcomes.....

- **Earn Credits:** students in inclusive courses were enrolled for standard IHE credit (54%). In most specialized courses (98%), students earned credit that could only be used towards TPSID credential.
- **Legitimacy of Credentials:** Students who primarily enrolled in inclusive courses in their final year were **MORE LIKELY** to earn a certificate available to all students at the IHE than students who primarily enrolled in specialized courses.



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Outcomes

61% students who completed a TPSID program had a **PAID JOB** one year after exit.



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Additional One Year Outcomes

- One-third of individuals were living alone, with a roommate, with their significant other or their living situation was not reported
- Two thirds of individuals were living with family 1 year after completing a TPSID program.
- Most individuals (92%) were either satisfied or very satisfied with their social life.



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“Students with ID, when given the expectation, opportunity, and needed supports and accommodations, **CAN** access college-level coursework, and, if desired, **CAN** earn college credits.”



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It's all about expectations.....



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